

Credibility & Counterarguments

Workbook 1 - Learn - Focused practice

Directions

Work slowly. Identify exactly what the source says before you decide what the evidence can support.

Exercise 1

A report asks how many emergency calls a fire department received last year.

Task: Which source is most credible for that claim?

- A. The fire department's official call records.
- B. A tourist blog.
- C. A restaurant menu.
- D. A student guessing from memory.

Exercise 2

An article argues for later library hours. A critic says staffing costs may rise. The author replies with the actual overtime cost from a four-week pilot.

Task: What does the reply do?

- A. It directly addresses the cost objection with relevant evidence.
- B. It ignores the objection.
- C. It changes the topic to book selection.
- D. It proves staffing is free.

Exercise 3

A company wants evidence about machine failure rates.

Task: Which source is most relevant?

- A. Maintenance logs maintained by the engineering team.
- B. A celebrity interview.
- C. A customer comment about parking.
- D. The cafeteria schedule.

Exercise 4

A writer says a new park plan may reduce parking spaces. An opponent says nearby shops will lose customers. The writer responds, "The park will look beautiful."

Task: How strong is the response?

- A. Weak, because it does not address the customer-loss concern.
- B. Strong, because beauty always increases sales.
- C. Strong, because it repeats the proposal.
- D. Irrelevant only because parks are outdoors.

Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

Exercise 1

Best answer: A. The fire department's official call records.

Why: The department directly records the information being asked about.

Exercise 2

Best answer: A. It directly addresses the cost objection with relevant evidence.

Why: The response answers the exact concern using measured cost data.

Exercise 3

Best answer: A. Maintenance logs maintained by the engineering team.

Why: They directly record the failures being evaluated.

Exercise 4

Best answer: A. Weak, because it does not address the customer-loss concern.

Why: The response changes the subject instead of answering the economic objection.

Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.